

CLASSROOM INTRODUCTIONS — BEGINNER CANTONESE

課室見面：打招呼同自我介紹

Original sample teaching material for a 15-minute university workshop.

Traditional Chinese + Jyutping tone numbers + English support.

阿欣 and 阿明 are fictional classroom characters. Learners can use these names.

Goal: Greet a teacher or classmate in Cantonese.

Goal: Introduce a fictional character and ask their name.

Goal: Say whether someone is a student or teacher.

Goal: Say which language a character studies and likes.

CORE VOCABULARY

Format: Traditional Chinese | Jyutping | English

你好 | nei5 hou2 | Hello

早晨 | zou2 san4 | Good morning

再見 | zoi3 gin3 | Goodbye

我 | ngo5 | I / me

你 | nei5 | You

係 | hai6 | To be / yes

唔係 | m4 hai6 | Not to be / no

叫 | giu3 | To be called

咩 | me1 | What

名 | meng2 | Name (colloquial pronunciation)

老師 | lou5 si1 | Teacher

學生 | hok6 saang1 | Student

同學 | tung4 hok6 | Classmate

學 | hok6 | To learn / study

中文 | zung1 man2 | Chinese language

英文 | jing1 man2 | English language

廣東話 | gwong2 dung1 waa2 | Cantonese language

鍾意 | zung1 ji3 | To like

香港 | hoeng1 gong2 | Hong Kong

香港人 | hoeng1 gong2 jan4 | A person from Hong Kong

TARGET EXPRESSIONS

我叫阿欣 | ngo5 giu3 aa3 jan1 | My name is Ah Yan

你叫咩名呀 | nei5 giu3 me1 meng2 aa3 | What is your name?

我係學生 | ngo5 hai6 hok6 saang1 | I am a student

我唔係老師 | ngo5 m4 hai6 lou5 si1 | I am not a teacher

你係唔係學生呀 | nei5 hai6 m4 hai6 hok6 saang1 aa3 | Are you a student?

我學廣東話 | ngo5 hok6 gwong2 dung1 waa2 | I study Cantonese

我鍾意學廣東話 | ngo5 zung1 ji3 hok6 gwong2 dung1 waa2 | I like learning Cantonese

你呢 | nei5 ne1 | How about you?

SECTION 1 — GREETINGS (3 MINUTES)

Situation: A teacher meets two students before a morning lesson.

Teaching point: Use 早晨 in the morning; use 你好 as a general greeting.

Dialogue: 老師：早晨！

Jyutping: lou5 si1: zou2 san4!

English: Teacher: Good morning!

Dialogue: 阿欣：老師，早晨！

Jyutping: aa3 jan1: lou5 si1, zou2 san4!

English: Ah Yan: Good morning, teacher!

Dialogue: 阿明：你好！

Jyutping: aa3 ming4: nei5 hou2!

English: Ah Ming: Hello!

Practice: Listen to 早晨 and choose "Good morning" rather than "Goodbye".

Practice: Match 你好 to "Hello", 早晨 to "Good morning", and 再見 to "Goodbye".

SECTION 2 — NAMES (4 MINUTES)

Situation: Two fictional classmates introduce themselves.

Teaching point: 我叫 + name introduces a person by name.

Grammar: 我叫 + name means "My name is ...".

Grammar: 你叫咩名呀? asks "What is your name?". 咩 means "what"; 呀 makes the spoken question friendly.

Dialogue: 阿欣：你好！我叫阿欣。你叫咩名呀？

Jyutping: aa3 jan1: nei5 hou2! ngo5 giu3 aa3 jan1. nei5 giu3 me1 meng2 aa3?

English: Ah Yan: Hello! My name is Ah Yan. What is your name?

Dialogue: 阿明：我叫阿明。你好！

Jyutping: aa3 ming4: ngo5 giu3 aa3 ming4. nei5 hou2!

English: Ah Ming: My name is Ah Ming. Hello!

Practice: Put 我 / 叫 / 阿欣 in order to form 我叫阿欣.

Practice: Complete 我___阿欣 with 叫.

Speaking target: 你叫咩名呀？

SECTION 3 — STUDENT OR TEACHER? (4 MINUTES)

Situation: A classmate checks whether Ah Yan is a student.

Teaching point: 係 states an identity; 唔係 denies it.

Grammar: 我係 + role means "I am ...". 我唔係 + role means "I am not ...".

Grammar: 係唔係 forms a yes/no question. 你係唔係學生呀? means "Are you a student?".

Dialogue: 阿明：你係唔係學生呀？

Jyutping: aa3 ming4: nei5 hai6 m4 hai6 hok6 saang1 aa3?

English: Ah Ming: Are you a student?

Dialogue: 阿欣：係，我係學生。我唔係老師。你呢？

Jyutping: aa3 jan1: hai6, ngo5 hai6 hok6 saang1. ngo5 m4 hai6 lou5 si1. nei5 ne1?

English: Ah Yan: Yes, I am a student. I am not a teacher. How about you?

Dialogue: 阿明：我都係學生。

Jyutping: aa3 ming4: ngo5 dou1 hai6 hok6 saang1.

English: Ah Ming: I am a student too.

Additional teaching note: 都 (dou1) means "also / too" in the final dialogue line.

Practice: Choose 我係學生 when the fictional character is a student.

Speaking target: 我係學生。

SECTION 4 — WHAT DO YOU STUDY? (4 MINUTES)

Situation: The same classmates talk about their language class.

Teaching point: 學 describes study; 鍾意 describes liking something.

Grammar: 我學 + language means "I study ...". 我鍾意學 + language means "I like learning ...".

Dialogue: 阿欣：我學廣東話。你呢？

Jyutping: aa3 jan1: ngo5 hok6 gwong2 dung1 waa2. nei5 ne1?

English: Ah Yan: I study Cantonese. How about you?

Dialogue: 阿明：我學英文。

Jyutping: aa3 ming4: ngo5 hok6 jing1 man2.

English: Ah Ming: I study English.

Dialogue: 阿欣：我鍾意學廣東話！

Jyutping: aa3 jan1: ngo5 zung1 ji3 hok6 gwong2 dung1 waa2!

English: Ah Yan: I like learning Cantonese!

Practice: Match 中文, 英文, and 廣東話 with their English meanings.

Speaking target: 我學廣東話。

Roleplay: Use Ah Yan and Ah Ming as fictional characters. Exchange greetings, ask a name, state a student identity, and say which language the character studies. Keep replies within this material.

CULTURE AND PRONUNCIATION

Culture: Address a teacher with 老師. A morning greeting such as 老師，早晨 is natural in a classroom.

Culture: Cantonese 廣東話 and Mandarin are different spoken varieties; pronunciation examples for this workshop should use Hong Kong Cantonese.

Pronunciation: Numbers 1–6 in Jyutping mark tones. Use Jyutping consistently; the reference screenshots use a different romanization system, Yale.

Pronunciation: 名 has the colloquial reading meng2 in 你叫咩名呀. 廣東話 uses the conversational reading waa2 here.

REVIEW ACTIVITIES AND ANSWER KEY

1. Greeting: Which phrase means "Good morning"? Answer: 早晨.

2. Vocabulary: Match 老師 / 學生 / 同學 to Teacher / Student / Classmate.
3. Sentence order: 我 / 叫 / 阿欣. Answer: 我叫阿欣.
4. Fill the blank: 我____學生. Answer: 係.
5. Listening: Hear 我學廣東話 and choose "I study Cantonese".
6. Speaking: Record 我係學生 and compare the recognized words with that phrase.
7. Conversation: Reply to 你叫咩名呀? with 我叫阿欣 or 我叫阿明.
8. Scenario: Greet your fictional teacher in the morning with 老師, 早晨.